

Facilitator Kit • Peer Coaching and Observation Guide

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

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FIELD COPY



PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

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Hackles Facilitator Kit, Document 6 of 10. How teachers help each other get better at teaching online safely: lesson study, peer observation, a rubric ("Is the lesson fun, safe, skill-based?"), feedback scripts and PLC meeting agendas.

[Logo: Hackles]

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No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

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01 Why peer coaching, and the ground rules

TEACHING A HACKLES LESSON well is a skill. Most of that skill comes from trying it, seeing how it lands, and trying it again. A trusted colleague with a clear rubric is the cheapest, fastest coach you can have. It also builds trust: teachers who watch each other teach talk more openly about safety.

Try this now (10 minutes, today): ask one colleague, "Can I watch the first five minutes of your next Hackles lesson and tell you two things that worked?" Use H13, write two glows, say them out loud the same day. That is the whole method; the rest of this guide just makes it smoother.

THE GROUND RULES (POST THESE IN THE PLC ROOM)

1. **Growth, not evaluation.** Peer coaching is separate from formal evaluation. No observation form goes in a personnel file, and no administrator reads it without the teacher's consent. [VERIFY with your contract, your union and your district's evaluation rules.]
2. **Voluntary and invited.** The teacher being observed chooses the lesson, the focus and the observer.
3. **Confidential.** What we see in each other's rooms stays in the PLC.
4. **No student data.** Observers never write down a child's name, a child's words that identify them, or anything about an individual student. We watch what **the class** does, not what any one child does.
5. **Kind and specific.** Every piece of feedback names the exact moment, in plain words.
6. **Two glows and a grow.** We always say what worked before we suggest a change.
7. **Safety first.** If a disclosure or safety concern arises, the observer stops observing and becomes an adult in the room. See Section 6.
8. **Fun on purpose.** If it is not fun, we are not done coaching.

WHAT PEER COACHING IS NOT

- It is not a gotcha.
- It is not grading.
- It is not a way to catch someone teaching a topic "wrong." If a lesson strays from the kit's safety guidance (scare tactics, shame, personal sharing, demonstrating attacks), the observer says so kindly, privately and the same day, using the scripts in Section 8, and tells the counselor if a student may have been harmed.

02 Three ways to coach (quick menu)

FORMAT	TIME	BEST FOR	WHAT YOU DO
A. Peer observation	5 min pre, 15 min lesson, 10 min debrief	Any teacher, any week	One colleague watches a 15-minute lesson with H13 and gives two glows and a grow
B. Micro-teach rehearsal	20 min	Before a new lesson	Practice the Hook and Activity for 3 minutes on a colleague, get feedback, then teach
C. Lesson study	6 weeks, 6 meetings	A grade-level team or small group	Plan one lesson together, one teacher teaches, the others observe, the team revises, a second teacher re-teaches

PICK ONE FORMAT PER teacher per term. Plan the observer's time honestly: a peer observation costs the observer about 30 minutes (5 pre, 15 lesson, 10 debrief), so arrange coverage with the ideas in Section 12. New teachers start with B, then A. Teams that have done A for a semester can try C.

03 The rubric: Is the lesson fun, safe, skill-based?

THIS RUBRIC IS THE heart of coaching. The one-page form is H13 in the Handouts. Use it on observation days. The descriptors below help you rate fairly.

Rating key: **N** = Not yet (not seen, or the opposite is seen). **G** = Getting there (partly in place). **Y** = Got it (clear and consistent).

FUN

Fun is not noise. Fun is engagement that is joyful and kind.

LOOK-FOR	N (NOT YET)	G (GETTING THERE)	Y (GOT IT)	COMMON FIX
FUN 1. Within 2 minutes, most students are moving, talking or hands-on.	The teacher talks for more than 4 minutes; most students are listening only	Some students are active; others wait	Almost everyone is doing something (standing, sorting, partner-talking, role-playing) by minute 2	Shorten the Hook to 2 minutes; move to the activity sooner
FUN 2. Laughter or energy is present and kind.	Flat tone, or laughter at a student's expense	A few smiles; humor is mostly the teacher's	Students laugh with each other; humor is warm and inclusive	Add a silly voice, a prop, a team name
FUN 3. Students have a role (not just listening).	One or two students answer; the rest are audience	Roles exist but are unequal	Every student has a role (captain, reader, sorter, observer)	Use pairs or teams; rotate roles

SAFE

Safe is not boring. Safe means every child can take part without being scared, shamed or exposed.

LOOK-FOR	N	G	Y	COMMON FIX
SAFE 1. No scare tactics, graphic detail or shaming.	Statistics or stories are used to frighten; a student is called out; "you should have known better" is said	Tone is mostly calm, but one slip occurs (a frightening example, a "careless" comment)	Calm and matter-of-fact throughout; "anyone can be tricked" is said	Replace the scary example with a fictional character; use the kit's "Use this, avoid this" language
SAFE 2. Pass is allowed; no one is asked to share personal experiences; practice uses characters and cards.	A student is asked "has this happened to you?" or pressed to share	Pass is allowed but no one is reminded	Teacher says "pass is always allowed"; every case is fictional	Add the group agreements; use a "Question Box"
SAFE 3. "Never your fault" and "tell, no trouble" are said aloud.	Not said, or "you should have..." is said	Said once, but quickly	Said clearly and repeated at the takeaway	Say it at the start and the end
SAFE 4. A route to tell is named, and the calm close is used.	Lesson ends abruptly; no trusted adults named	A trusted adult is named, but no route (note box, counselor)	Trusted adults named; a way to tell privately named; a calm closing breath	Use the calm closing script from the Counselor Toolkit

SKILL-BASED

Skill-based means students **do** something they can repeat tomorrow.

LOOK-FOR	N	G	Y	COMMON FIX
SKILL 1. One clear skill is practiced by students (said, acted or built), not just discussed.	The lesson is a discussion or a lecture	Skill is mentioned and partly practiced	Students practice one skill aloud or by hand and could repeat it	Name the skill in one sentence; add a 2-minute practice
SKILL 2. The lesson ends with Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. and one takeaway.	No takeaway, or too many	The routine is said but the takeaway is unclear	One takeaway; the routine and hand signals are used	Use a one-line takeaway; end with the signals
SKILL 3. The teacher praised the Pause or the Tell, not "being right."	Praise is for correct answers or speed	Mixed	The teacher praises noticing, pausing, checking and telling, including false alarms	Say "good gut check" and "thank you for telling" often

BONUS LOOK-FORS (NOT SCORED)

- **Time:** did the lesson fit the 2, 8, 3, 2 shape?
- **Inclusion:** could every child take part (seated option, words and pictures, a way to point instead of speak, home language support)?
- **Transfer:** did the teacher link the skill to a real-life setting without asking anyone to share a story?
- **Calm exit:** was the closing calm, with a breath or a stretch?

SCORING AND USING THE SCORES

- **Do not add up the scores.** Do not compare teachers. A rating is a conversation starter, not a grade.
- **Look at patterns, not single items.** A "G" on FUN 3 is common in a first lesson.
- **Pick one grow.** Never give more than one grow in a debrief.

04 Band-by-band: what fun, safe and skill-based look like

BAND	FUN LOOKS LIKE	SAFE LOOKS LIKE	SKILL-BASED LOOKS LIKE
K-2 (ages 5-7)	Movement, silly voices, a prop, a song or chant, the Oops Button, floor ladders	Simple words ("yucky, confusing or scary"), no brand names, no "dangerous," never "stranger" as the only message, "a grown-up who helps," Pass allowed, picture-based exit ticket	Children say "I'll ask," "I'll tell," press the Oops Button, do the Pause Palm
3-5 (ages 8-10)	Team sorts, crack-timer races, floor ladder, role-play in trios, secret code lab	Characters not real kids, no "has this happened to you," SPOT used calmly, "never your fault" said	Students sort with SPOT, build a passphrase, climb the ladder aloud, call back a code word
6-8 (ages 11-13)	Case files, FLAGS bookmark, team challenges, drill cards	Fictional case files; no "gotcha" tone; Question Box; counselor heads-up for sensitive lessons	Students analyze a DM with FLAGS, rehearse the Help Ladder and the stop, keep (messages only, never an intimate image), tell, report steps in words
9-12 (ages 14-18)	Debates, mosaics, verify labs, threat models, helper role-plays, student teach-backs	Plain, respectful tone; five agreements; Question Box; no stats as fear hooks; honest limit on confidentiality said aloud	Students use Pause-Check-Tell as a decision habit; say the sentence out loud to a partner

In grades 6-12 the mascot Hackle appears only as a small corner icon and never in dialogue.

05 Peer observation: the 3-step cycle

STEP 1: PRE-CONFERENCE (5 MINUTES)

DO THIS THE DAY before or the morning of.

The teacher says:

- Which lesson, which band and how many students.
- One thing I want you to look for (a focus): fun, safe or skill.
- One thing I am nervous about.
- Where you will sit and what you will do (usually: sit at the back, take notes, do not help or interrupt).

The observer says:

- "I'll be a fly on the wall. I'll write what I see, not what I think."
- "I will not write names or anything about individual students."
- "If a student tells you something serious during the lesson, I'll stop observing and help in whatever way you ask."

Complete the Pre-Observation Form (Section 10).

STEP 2: OBSERVE (THE 15-MINUTE LESSON)

Observer's jobs

1. Sit where you can see the whole class and the teacher.
2. Use H13. Record **evidence** (what you saw and heard), not opinions.
3. Count roles: how many students are doing something at minute 2? (Do not count names; just a rough fraction: most, half, few.)
4. Record time: when did the Hook end? the Activity? the Discuss? the Takeaway?
5. Notice the language: did the teacher say "never your fault," "tell, no trouble," or "keep telling until someone helps"?
6. Notice what the teacher praised (the Pause? the Tell? being right?).
7. Do not interrupt or help unless asked.
8. If a safety concern arises, see Section 6.

What not to write: student names, student quotes that identify a child, descriptions of any child's body, clothes, family or behavior. If you must note something, write "a student" and nothing else.

STEP 3: DEBRIEF (10 MINUTES, SAME DAY IF POSSIBLE)

Use this protocol.

MIN	STEP	WHO	SCRIPT
0:00-1:00	Teacher first	Teacher	"What went well? What would you change?"
1:00-4:00	Two glows	Observer	"I noticed ____ at ____ (minute). That made ____ happen." Name the exact moment.
4:00-7:00	One grow	Observer	"What if you tried ____?" Offer one concrete suggestion.
7:00-9:00	Try it now	Teacher	Teacher repeats 30 seconds of the lesson with the change, or says exactly what they would say next time
9:00-10:00	Steal and plan	Both	"What I want to steal." "One thing I will do Monday."

AFTER THE DEBRIEF

- The observer gives the teacher the form, and the teacher chooses to keep or destroy it.
- Both complete the Post-Observation Reflection (Section 10) in two minutes.
- Schedule a swap: the teacher observes the observer within three weeks.

06 Observing sensitive lessons (special rules)

SENSITIVE LESSONS ARE THE ones listed in the Counselor Heads-Up and Opt-Out Toolkit (for example grooming patterns, sextortion response, fakes that hurt, body safety, coercion in relationships online, being a helper). They are more likely to prompt disclosures.

1. **No peer observation of a sensitive lesson without the counselor's agreement and the teacher's invitation.** The family pre-notice and heads-up have to be done first. [VERIFY your district's rules on visitors in the room during sensitive instruction.]
2. **Prefer a counselor as the observer** for a sensitive lesson.
3. **No video recording** of any lesson, ever, unless your district and families have approved it in writing. [VERIFY] The default is paper notes with no names.
4. **If a student discloses or becomes distressed during an observed lesson:** the observer stops observing, puts the form away, and becomes an adult in the room. The teacher leads; the observer supports (for example by taking the rest of the class through a calm activity or going to find the counselor). The observer does not take notes about the student. Both follow the Disclosure and Incident Guide.
5. **If the observer is concerned about the lesson's safety:** use the "Safety Slip" script in Section 8 (privately, the same day).
6. **Debrief the teacher, too.** Teaching a sensitive lesson can be hard. Add one question to the debrief: "How are you doing?"
7. **Debrief with the counselor** if any disclosure occurred (without student identifiers on the observation form).

07 Lesson study: the six-week cycle

LESSON STUDY IS A team method that comes from a long tradition of teachers improving a single lesson together. In this version, a small team (3 to 5 teachers, ideally of the same band) works on one Hackles lesson, one non-sensitive lesson at first.

THE CYCLE AT A GLANCE

WEEK	MEETING	WHAT HAPPENS
1	PLC 1: Choose and read	Pick one lesson. Read it. Name the research question ("How do we make this lesson more fun without losing safety?").
2	PLC 2: Co-plan	Plan the lesson together. Rehearse the Hook and the Activity. Decide what observers will look for.
3	PLC 3: Teach and observe	One teacher teaches the research lesson . The others observe with H13.
3	Debrief (same day, 20 minutes)	The team debriefs with Two Glows and a Grow.
4	PLC 4: Revise	Revise the lesson based on what was seen. Decide what changes.
5	Re-teach	A second teacher teaches the revised lesson. The team observes again.
6	PLC 6: Share out (PLC 5, Learn From the Class, can run any time after a lesson)	The team shares what they learned and posts the improved lesson notes for the building (staff room or shared folder).

WHAT OBSERVERS LOOK AT

Observers watch **the class**, not the teacher alone. Three focus questions:

1. When were students most engaged, and what was happening?
2. When did the energy dip, and what was happening?
3. Were there any signals of discomfort (a quiet pause, a card flipped down, a student leaving)? Note the moment only, not who. Tell the counselor if a pattern occurs.

WHAT A RESEARCH LESSON LOOKS LIKE

Choose a lesson from the safe list (any lesson not on the Counselor Toolkit's sensitive list). Good starter lessons: K-2 Lesson 3 "Pause and Ask," 3-5 Lesson 3 "Scam Spotters," 6-8 Lesson 3 "Phish Lab," 9-12 Lesson 3 "Social Engineering Case Lab."

LESSON STUDY ROLES

- **Teaching teacher** (teaches the research lesson).
- **Observers** (2 to 4).
- **Facilitator** (rotates; the Hackles Mentor, if there is one).
- **Counselor** (joins PLC 2 and PLC 6 for safety advice).

LESSON STUDY NORMS

- Plan every minute (2, 8, 3, 2).
- Decide in advance what each observer will watch.
- Never present a lesson as a "failure." The lesson was the one we studied.
- The final write-up is **one page**: what we changed and why.

08 Feedback scripts

THE CORE FRAME: TWO GLOWS AND A GROW

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
"I noticed ___ at about minute _____. That made ___ happen." (Glow)	
"I noticed ___ when _____. It seemed to ____." (Glow)	
"What if you tried ___?" (Grow)	
"Want to try it right now?" (Try it now)	

SAMPLE GLOWS

- "I noticed that when you held up the pop-up, everyone grabbed their palms at the same time. The whole room became one body."
- "I noticed that you said 'good gut check' to a student who said the message felt off but couldn't say why. That made three more students share."
- "I noticed that you ended with the hand signals and everyone did them."
- "I noticed that you said 'pass is always allowed' and I saw two students relax."

SAMPLE GROWS (WITH A CONCRETE MOVE)

WHAT YOU SAW	SAY THIS
The Hook ran 5 minutes	"What if you cut the story after the first example and went straight to the sort? You'd save three minutes for the Discuss."
Only a few students spoke	"What if you tried partner talk for 30 seconds before cold-calling? More voices, less pressure."
The takeaway had three ideas	"What if you picked one: 'Pause and ask.' Everything else goes in the exit ticket."
The teacher praised correct answers	"What if you praised the pause? 'I love that you paused before you answered.'"
No route to tell was named	"What if you ended with 'Who are our trusted adults? Here's the note box?'"

SCRIPTS FOR HARD MOMENTS

When a teacher is defensive. "I can tell you care a lot about this lesson, and I've noticed it. I want to start with what I saw that worked. Can I share two things first?" (Then: "Does that match what you felt? What would you like to look at next time?")

When a teacher is very self-critical. "I hear you being hard on yourself. Here's what I saw: [two specifics]. Teaching a new lesson is like learning a new sport. Let's pick one small thing to try."

When a teacher is anxious about disclosures. "It's normal to worry about that. You already know the First 10 Minutes: thank, no blame, no secrets, report. Want to practice it for two minutes?"

When an observer sees a safety concern (the Safety Slip).

FIELD NOTE	No. 2
"Thanks for letting me watch. I want to share one thing, privately and kindly, because I care about the kids and about you. At about minute ____, I heard _____. The kit's guidance asks us to avoid ____ because _____. What would you like to do next time? I'd be happy to help you rework it, or we can go to [counselor] together."	

Use this for: scare statistics, shaming ("you should have known better"), asking students to share a personal experience, naming a real child, demonstrating an attack, promising secrecy. If a student may have been harmed by the lesson (visibly upset, withdrawn), involve the counselor the same day.

When the observer sees something truly concerning about a child (not the lesson). Stop. Follow the Disclosure and Incident Guide. Do not record it on the form.

When a teacher asks, "Was it good?" "I'm not the judge. But I can tell you what I saw that I'd steal. Two things..."

HOW TO RECEIVE FEEDBACK

- Say "thank you."
- Take notes.
- Ask one clarifying question.
- Choose one thing to try.
- Do not defend; there will be time.

09 PLC meeting agendas (six 30-minute meetings)

USE THESE AS A sequence across a semester (see the lesson study cycle) or pick any one.

PLC 1: CHOOSE AND READ (30 MINUTES)

MIN	ACTIVITY
0-3	Opener: Hackles Up signal and a one-word check-in ("one word for how you feel about teaching online safety").
3-8	Norms: read the ground rules (Section 1). Thumbs-up check.
8-18	Choose a lesson: read the 15-minute version aloud from the Teacher Guide. Mark the Hook, Activity, Discuss, Takeaway.
18-25	Research question: "How might we make this lesson more fun without losing safety?" Write it on a sticky note.
25-28	Plan observations: who teaches, who observes, when.
28-30	Takeaway: one sentence. "Plan the lesson together before we teach it."

PLC 2: CO-PLAN (30 MINUTES)

MIN	ACTIVITY
0-3	Opener: Simon Says with the four signals.
3-8	Rehearse the Hook: the teaching teacher delivers the Hook; the team gives one glow.
8-18	Rehearse the Activity: the team plays the students. Time it.
18-24	Safety review (with the counselor if possible): read the lesson's "If a student discloses" box. Rehearse the calm opening and closing.
24-28	Observation plan: who watches what (fun, safe, skill). Review H13.
28-30	Takeaway: one sentence. "Fun, safe, skill-based."

PLC 3: TEACH AND OBSERVE (LESSON DAY + 20-MINUTE DEBRIEF)

MIN	ACTIVITY
Before	Pre-conference (5 minutes)
During	The research lesson (15 minutes; observers use H13)
0-3	Debrief opener: the teaching teacher shares one thing that went well and one thing they would change.
3-13	Two glows each: each observer shares two glows, with the exact moment.
13-18	One grow: the team chooses one grow for the revision.
18-20	Takeaway: one sentence. "One change for next time."

PLC 4: REVISE (30 MINUTES)

MIN	ACTIVITY
0-3	Opener: each person shares one steal from the observation.
3-15	Revise: rewrite the Hook, Activity or Takeaway for the one chosen grow. Update the lesson notes.
15-22	Rehearse: the second teaching teacher practices the revised lesson.
22-27	Plan the re-teach observation.
27-30	Takeaway: one sentence. "Small changes, big difference."

PLC 5: LEARN FROM THE CLASS (30 MINUTES) (DATA-FREE)

This meeting looks at **classroom artifacts**, not student data. Teachers may bring anonymous exit tickets or the pictures from a lesson, with names covered. Nothing is uploaded or recorded. **No student names, no scores, no tracking of individuals.**

MIN	ACTIVITY
0-3	Opener: one word about the class.
3-8	Sort exit tickets in themes (for example: "mentioned telling," "named a trusted adult," "unsure what to do"). Names covered.
8-18	What do the themes tell us about the lesson? Not about any child.
18-25	Adjust the next lesson: one change.
25-28	Plan the re-teach if needed.
28-30	Takeaway: "We learn from the class without tracking the child."

PLC 6: SHARE OUT AND SENSITIVE-LESSON READINESS (30 MINUTES)

MIN	ACTIVITY
0-3	Opener: the Win Wall. Each person writes one win on a sticky note.
3-10	Share out: each team shares the one-page lesson update.
10-18	Sensitive lesson readiness (with the counselor): timeline game (3 weeks, 2 weeks, 1 week, 2 days, day of, 24 hours, 1 week after). Check the heads-up, pre-notice and opt-out steps. [VERIFY policy]
18-25	Support plan: who covers whom if a teacher needs a break; how the counselor will debrief teachers.
25-28	Next steps: who will be a Hackles Mentor? Who will lead the next micro-PD?
28-30	Takeaway: "Know your people. Support each other."

10 **Forms****PRE-OBSERVATION FORM (THE TEACHER FILLS IT IN, 2 MINUTES)**

FIELD	ENTR Y
Teacher	
Observer	
Date and period	
Band and lesson	
Is this a sensitive lesson? (If yes, was the counselor heads-up sent, family pre-notice sent and counselor agreement obtained?)	
What I am trying	
What I want you to look for (fun, safe or skill)	
What I am nervous about	
Where the observer will sit	
If something serious comes up during the lesson, I would like the observer to	

POST-OBSERVATION REFLECTION (BOTH FILL IT IN, 2 MINUTES)

FIELD	TEACHER	OBSERVER
One thing that worked		
One thing I will try next time (the grow)		
One thing I will steal		
One thing I would like help with		
How I am doing (1 to 5)		
The date of our swap		

The observation form itself is H13 in the Handouts file.

11 Coaching the coach: building Hackles Mentors

A **Hackles Mentor** is a teacher or staff member who guides others (see the Train-the-Trainer Guide). Mentors use peer coaching as their main tool.

MENTOR COACHING MOVES

1. **Ask first:** "What would you like to look at?"
2. **See it:** observe with H13, in the teacher's room, with permission.
3. **Say it:** two glows and a grow, with the exact moment.
4. **Try it:** the teacher repeats 30 seconds with the change.
5. **Swap:** the mentor invites the teacher to observe the mentor's class.
6. **Celebrate:** end with a win.

A MENTOR'S OWN GROWTH

- Observe a mentor colleague once a term.
- Attend a Hackles Mentor circle (see the Train-the-Trainer Guide).
- Rehearse the Say This, Not That card monthly.
- Take care of yourself. Coaching on sensitive topics is emotional labor.

12 Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
Teachers fear observation	Start with Format B (micro-teach rehearsal). Observe the observer first. Remind them it is not evaluation.
No time for observation	Use 10-minute peer "drop-ins" for the Hook and Activity only. Or use a micro-teach in a staff meeting.
Substitute coverage is the barrier	Use a shared planning period; or have a counselor, librarian or administrator co-teach while the teacher observes.
An observer cannot stop giving advice	Hand them a card that says "Two glows and ONE grow."
An administrator wants the forms	The forms stay with the teacher. Offer an anonymous summary of themes instead. [VERIFY with your contract and policy]
A teacher teaches a sensitive lesson without notice	Ask the counselor to join the teacher, kindly and the same day. Check the heads-up and notice steps.
A teacher uses scare tactics	Use the Safety Slip script; offer to co-plan the Hook.
A student discloses during an observation	Follow Section 6. Do not record details.
Teachers disagree about fun versus rigor	Remind them: "Fun gets them in. Safe keeps them in. Skill gets them out better equipped." All three.
Observation feels like a performance	Change the focus: observe the students' activity, not the teacher.

This guide is educational guidance, not legal advice. Consult your administrator, your contract and your district counsel. [VERIFY]